Designing Irrigation Dashboards Farmers Trust

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ABSTRACT

Small farms receive more sensor data than they can act on. I designed three irrigation dashboards of increasing simplicity and tested them with 18 farmers in Yolo County. The simplest design, a single "water today / skip today" card with the reason underneath, cut the time to a watering decision from 74 to 31 seconds and was preferred by 15 of 18 participants.

1 · INTRODUCTION

Soil-moisture sensors are now cheap. Reading them is not. Farmers told me they check the numbers, then water the way their parents did...